

IGCSE World Literature

Grade 10 Syllabus 2025–26

Teacher: Mr. Peck, Office: Library Building, 510

Course Overview

Welcome to IGCSE World Literature.

This course develops the reading, writing, and thinking skills needed for international university life. It addresses the importance of understanding how culture, in the form of literature, is communication on a higher level than mere language acquisition. It explores how writers use English to create meaning. On this course you will develop your own informed response to literature.

You will also develop comprehension, analysis, writing, critical thinking, and project-based learning (PBL) skills that encourage independent learning. The course aims to foster curious, critical readers and reflective writers, able to see how literature connects to universal human experiences.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this course, you should be able to:

- Enjoy the experience of reading literature.
- Develop an informed personal response to a wide range of texts.
- Build skills in comprehension, analysis, writing, and critical thinking.
- Work collaboratively to explore ideas through PBL activities.

Materials

We will study a range of works this year, including (but not limited to):

- Shirley Jackson, *The Lottery*
- William Shakespeare, *Romeo and Juliet*
- Roald Dahl, *Lamb to the Slaughter*
- Ken Liu, *The Paper Menagerie*
- Franz Kafka, *Metamorphosis*

These texts will be provided for you, as will your notebook. However, you will need to acquire a 60-sleeve folder used only for this class.

Semester 1 - Class Content

The Lottery (Shirley Jackson)

Comprehension: Plot & characters

Analysis: Foreshadowing, irony

Writing: Suspense

Critical Thinking: Tradition & morality

PBL: Traditions

Romeo and Juliet – Act 1

Comprehension: Family feuds, character introduction

Analysis: Dramatic irony

Writing: Character sketch

Critical Thinking: Loyalty vs. freedom

PBL: Group conflict vs individuals

Lamb to the Slaughter (Roald Dahl)

Comprehension: Sequence, turning point

Analysis: Dark humor, irony

Writing: Perspective

Critical Thinking: Point of view

PBL: Judging events

Romeo and Juliet – Act 2

Comprehension: Describing the Balcony scene, secret marriage

Analysis: Imagery, Metaphor

Writing: Character Development and Comparison

Critical Thinking: Rational choices

PBL: Staging and interpretation

Romeo and Juliet – Act 3

Comprehension: Explaining Tybalt's death, Romeo's banishment

Analysis: Juxtaposition

Writing: Cause and effect

Critical Thinking: Responsibility

Rules and Expectations

You are High School students. The expectations are high:

- Respect the class: Show respect for the teacher, your peers, the classroom, and yourself.
- Be on time: Be ready to work when the bell sounds.
- Be responsible: Use Gibbon and the class WeChat to catch up on missed work.
- Be engaged: Speak in English, participate actively, and contribute positively.
- Be prepared – Bring your notebook, course materials, and homework planner to every class. Homework must be completed on time.

Assessment

Continuous assessment: 20%

Class participation: 30%

Examinations (mid-term and final): 50%

Contact Information

A class WeChat group will be created.

If you need to contact me, I am available during school hours (08:00–16:20) and may be available until 20:45 during evening study.

PBL: Reporting and interpretation

The Paper Menagerie (Ken Liu)

Comprehension: Life Stages

Analysis: Symbolism

Writing: Personal Reflection essay

Critical Thinking: Culture, Heritage, Identity

PBL: Family stories and Identity

Romeo and Juliet – Act 4

Comprehension: Discussing Juliet's dilemma

Analysis: Fate & Foreshadowing

Writing: Persuasive Writing

Critical Thinking: Evaluating Choices

PBL: Performance Choices and Interpretation

Romeo and Juliet – Act 5

- Comprehension: Sequencing the tragedy
- Analysis: Fate and human error
- Writing: Analytical essay
- Critical Thinking: What if...?
- PBL: Alternative Endings